

Business Registration Plan - Tool Stack

Site: <https://toolstack.page> | Generated: 2026-09-30 | Country: Germany

Part 1 - Register NOW (before end of 2026)

1. Gewerbeanmeldung (trade office)

City trade office (online form in most cities). Activity: 'Website with product reviews / affiliate marketing'. Legal form: Einzelunternehmer (sole proprietor). Cost: approx EUR 20-60. Bring ID + address. Takes under 1 hour.

2. Tax registration (ELSTER)

elster.de -> create account -> 'Fragebogen zur steuerlichen Erfassung' (deadline: within 1 month of starting). Tick: Gewerbebetrieb, Kleinunternehmer (sec. 19 VAT Act), 0 employees. You receive a Steuernummer. Keep the confirmation - PartnerStack payout will ask for it.

3. Health insurance note

Report self-employment to your Krankenkasse if your family-insurance status requires it.

4. DRV (pension) status check

Optional now, recommended: DRV Statusfeststellung (drv-bund.de) if you also hold employment insured in Germany - possible exemption as part-time employed with low self-employment profit.

5. Keep proof

Keep: Anmeldung document, ELSTER confirmation, any DRV reply. The 2027 law uses the registration date to sort 'existing' vs 'new' self-employed.

Part 2 - The 2027 pension-insurance reform (planned)

What is changing

The government coalition committed to implementing the pension commission's recommendation: ALL self-employed without another mandatory pension system must join the statutory pension insurance. Legislative process targeted to finish by END OF 2026; obligation planned to START 2027 (exact cutoff set in the final law).

Existing vs new self-employed

REGISTERED BEFORE THE CUTOFF: inclusion planned, but with an OPT-OUT (currently proposed unconditional - no proof of private pension needed). REGISTERED AFTER THE CUTOFF: mandatory from day one, NO opt-out.

Cost figures (2026 values)

Full regular contribution: EUR 735.63/month. Founder discount (3 years): EUR 367.82/month (approx EUR 4,400/year). Income-based option: 18.6% of declared profit with a minimum contribution.

Your window

Registering the Gewerbe in 2026 most likely makes Tool Stack an 'existing' business before the cutoff: keeps the opt-out choice. Registering 2027 = full mandatory contribution regardless of income. Estimated value of acting now: EUR 400 - 5,000/year depending on revenue.

Important caveats

1) Not yet law - draft stage; cutoff date and transition rules open. 2) What counts as 'existing' (registration date vs first income) to be defined in the final text. 3) In January 2027: re-check the final transition rules and file the opt-out promptly if chosen. 4) Information, not legal advice.

December follow-up (automated)

The site's agent checks the final law's transition rules in December and reports: does 'existing self-employed' include 2026 Gewerbeanmeldung, how to file the opt-out, by which deadline.

Sources

- fuer-gruender.de/blog/rentenpflicht-ab-2027 (updated 2026-09-29)
- br.de: Rente fuer Selbststaendige - was die Regierung plant
- deutsche-rentenversicherung.de: Aenderungen 2026 (18.12.2025)
- NZA 9/2026: BMAS draft on status determination